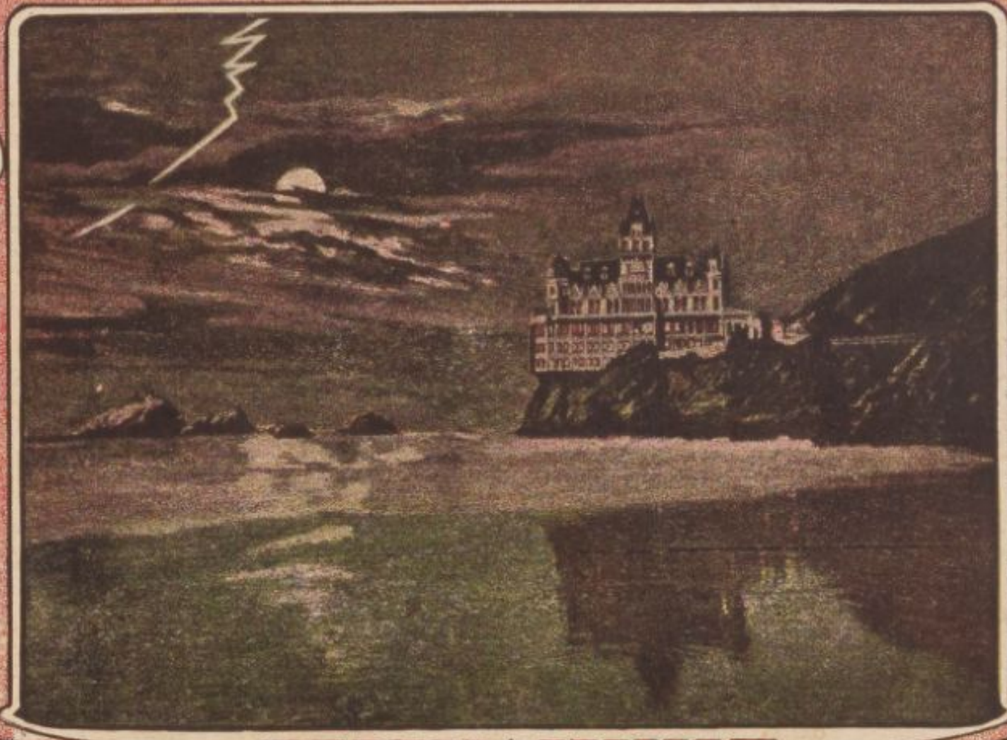
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San Francisco and Vicinity



Before and After The Great Fire.

San Francisco AND Vicinity

Before and After the Big Fire

APRIL 18th, 19th and 20th, 1906



The Burning City

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THE DESTRUCTION OF SAN FRANCISCO

The dawn of Wednesday, April 18, 1906, in San Francisco was as beautifully calm as a thousand others that had heralded delightful days to four hundred and fifty thousand souls, when, at 5:13 o'clock, with subterranean roar, the temblor racked and rent the trembling earth. Instantly, it seemed, the streets were filled with men, women and children, praying, shrieking, in frenzy. Buildings swayed and were tumbled into heaps of ruins;—the graves of hundreds. It was a ghastly horror, more dreadful than battlefields. But the worst,—the great destroyer, the grim leveler,—was to come, the Conflagration that was to destroy the work of fifty years of effort.

In three minutes after the first shock of earthquake the city was ablaze in a dozen districts. The rending of the earth had broken the water-mains in innumerable places and there was no hope;—the city was doomed. In an hour a hundred structures were blazing furnaces, the city was under martial law, the streets were patrolled by cavalry and infantry regiments.

In desperation dynamite was freely used in attempts, at many points, to conquer the fire, and hundreds of beautiful and costly buildings were blown to atoms, but it was of little avail and flames leaped from building to building, from street to street.

Before the end of the first day the whole of the business section was a seething holocaust,—a royal sacrifice to the Firegod. Masses of tortured steel and heaps of hot brick and stone were all that remained to grimly represent hundreds of millions of dollars in cost. The great bank buildings, the many storied Mills building, the Crocker building, the conspicuous "Call" building, the "Chronicle" and the "Examiner" buildings and the immense Merchants Exchange building, just completed, and a hundred other notable structures were heaps of ashes, or at best had but the outer walls, blackened, cracked and twisted, remaining as hideous land-marks. No picture however faithful can adequately portray the desolation.

Thursday morning broke and San Francisco lay under a black pall of smoke a mile high. The reflection of the fire could be seen fifty miles away. And still there was no water;—none to fight the flames, none even to drink for many thousands parched with the awful heat.

And the exodus from the city,—who can convincingly tell of its realities? What comparisons can convey its incidents truthfully to the minds of those who saw it not? The flight from Moscow was enacted again and the siege of Paris was repeated.

The fleeing populace, gathered from the four corners of the globe,—tens upon tens of thousands of them,—tramping in endless processions to safety, with the women and children and pitiful belongings, hastily gathered, in automobiles, in carriages, in hearses, in dirt-wagons, in wheel-barrows, in trunks and boxes painfully dragged over the "hundred hills." It was a motley mob, ash-covered and grimy, of many nationalities;—Chinese, Negroes, Mexicans, Greeks, Japanese, Turks, Arabians and all the races of Europe were there hurried onward by the fear of death. Conventionality was forgotten. One man's life was as good as another's. Millionaire and pauper, women in silks and their sisters in tatters, marched bravely on, and each, out of sympathy born of a common misfortune, lent a helping hand to the other, and, in that fearful second night, lay down together in utter exhaustion.

And then, working with endurance and bravery beyond belief or praise, the firemen and soldiers, after the palatial homes on Van Ness Avenue had been sacrificed by dynamite, subdued the flames on the third day and one-third, perhaps, of the city was saved. But the scene of annihilation already covered nine square miles,—four hundred and fifty city blocks. Market street, from end to end, was a black waste. Northward to the bay was only devastation. Southward, for a mile, was a ruin, while westward to Twentieth Street, in the Mission, the ground was almost as bare as when the Spaniard first landed. The wholesale, retail, manufacturing sections and more than half the residence districts, lay in ashes.

No conflagration at all comparable with this one has occurred in this country;—perhaps not in the world. The dead numbers many hundreds. The property loss is conservatively stated at three hundred millions of dollars and the insurance loss at one hundred and fifty millions.

Only hope and courage are left and these, coupled with determination and an indomitable spirit, heritage of the Pioneers of '49, will give birth to a new and greater San Francisco, which phoenix-like, will rise from the ashes of the old San Francisco, dear to many hearts the world over.

While the fearful events in San Francisco were taking place, many smaller cities in California suffered terribly. Beautiful San Jose was literally shaken to pieces. Hardly a building remained uninjured when the earthquake had spent its savage force. Her dead number over two hundred. The magnificent buildings of the Leland Stanford, Junior, University were, many of them, completely wrecked. Oakland, Watsonville, Santa Rosa, Hollister, Salinas, Santa Cruz and many other towns of importance, suffered great damage. Californians congratulate themselves in the knowledge that no great earthquake has ever recurred in the same place.

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The burned district of San Francisco is shown within the heavy black lines, the general boundaries being the water front from Brannan street on the east to Jones street on the north, thence along Jones to Chestnut, to Hyde, to Polk, to Filbert, to Van Ness avenue, to Clay, to Franklin, to Sutter, to Van Ness avenue, to Golden Gate avenue, to Octavia, to Page, to Gough, to Market to Doroles, to Twentieth, to Mission, to Eighteenth, to Howard, to Fifteenth, to Folsom, to Bryant, to the water front.



VIEW ON MARKET ST., FROM FERRY TOWER, SHOWING TROLLEY LINE IN OPERATION AND RAILROAD TRACKS BEING LAID TO REMOVE THE DEBRIS.

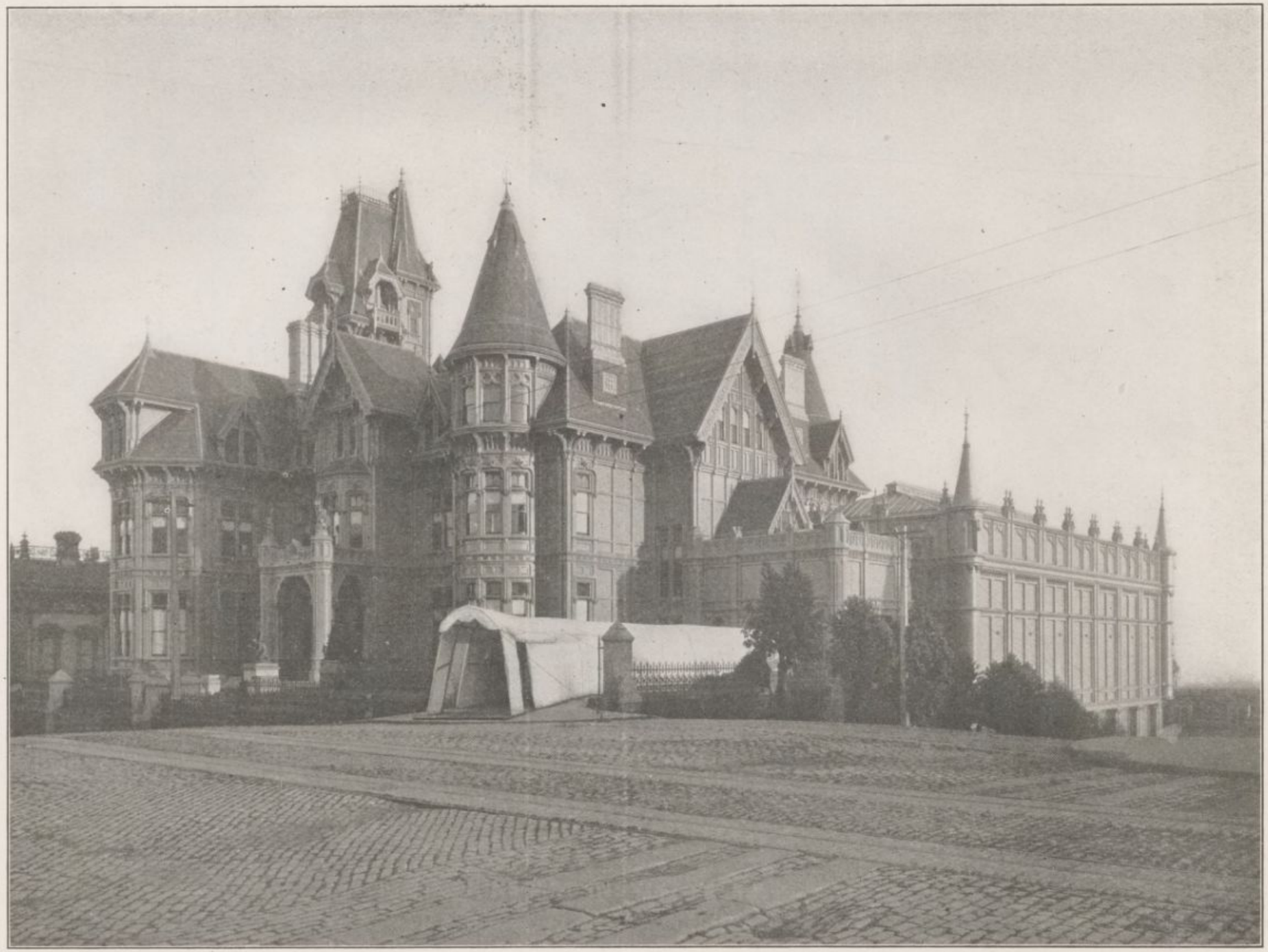


THE LOWER PORTION OF MARKET STREET ABLAZE, DURING THE PROGRESS OF THE FIRE.

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PALACE HOTEL AND SUTTER FOUNTAIN AT MARKET AND NEW MONTGOMERY STS. BEFORE THE FIRE.



THE MARK HOPKINS INSTITUTE OF ART, COR. OF CALIFORNIA AND MASON STS. BEFORE THE FIRE.



THE CITY HALL AFTER THE DISASTER.



CITY HALL AND HALL OF RECORDS. COMMENCED IN 1871,; COST OVER $6,000,000; OCCUPYING TWO BLOCKS OF LAND. THE MAIN DOME 335 FT., SURMOUNTED BY A FIGURE OF PROGRESS. BEFORE THE FIRE.



THE INNER COURT OF THE PALACE HOTEL AS IT WAS BEFORE THE FIRE.



DYING EMBERS OF METROPOLITAN TEMPLE, AN OLD LAND MARK
OF SAN FRANCISCO, ON FIFTH ST.,OPPOSITE THE MINT. Copyrighted, 1906, by W. J. Street



THE OLD FLOOD BUILDING AT FOURTH AND MARKET ST. IN THE GRIP OF THE FIRE.

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THE FAIRMOUNT HOTEL, NOB HILL. BEFORE THE FIRE.



36 "The silent sentinal among the ruins". Marie Antonette Apartments on Van Ness Ave., after the fire of April 18,19,20 - '06. San Francisco.



40 The Ferry Building viewed from the ruined business blocks on Mission St., after the fire San Francisco, April 18 - 20, 1906.

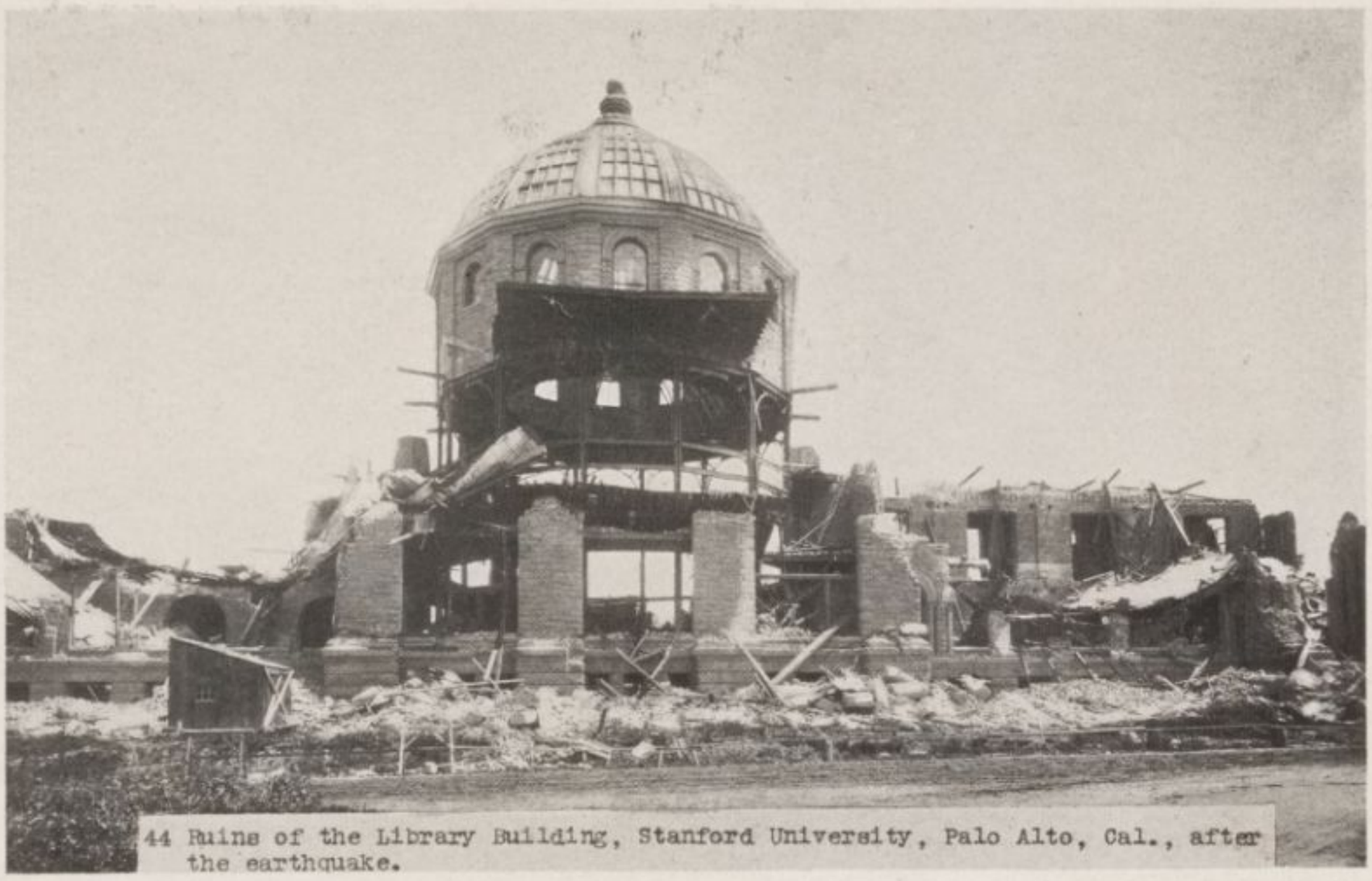
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THE FIRE WORKING ITS WAY OUT MARKET STREET, AS VIEWED FROM GRANT AVENUE.



CALIFORNIA STREET HILL FROM KEARNEY ST., BEFORE THE FIRE.



44 Ruins of the Library Building, Stanford University, Palo Alto, Cal., after the earthquake.



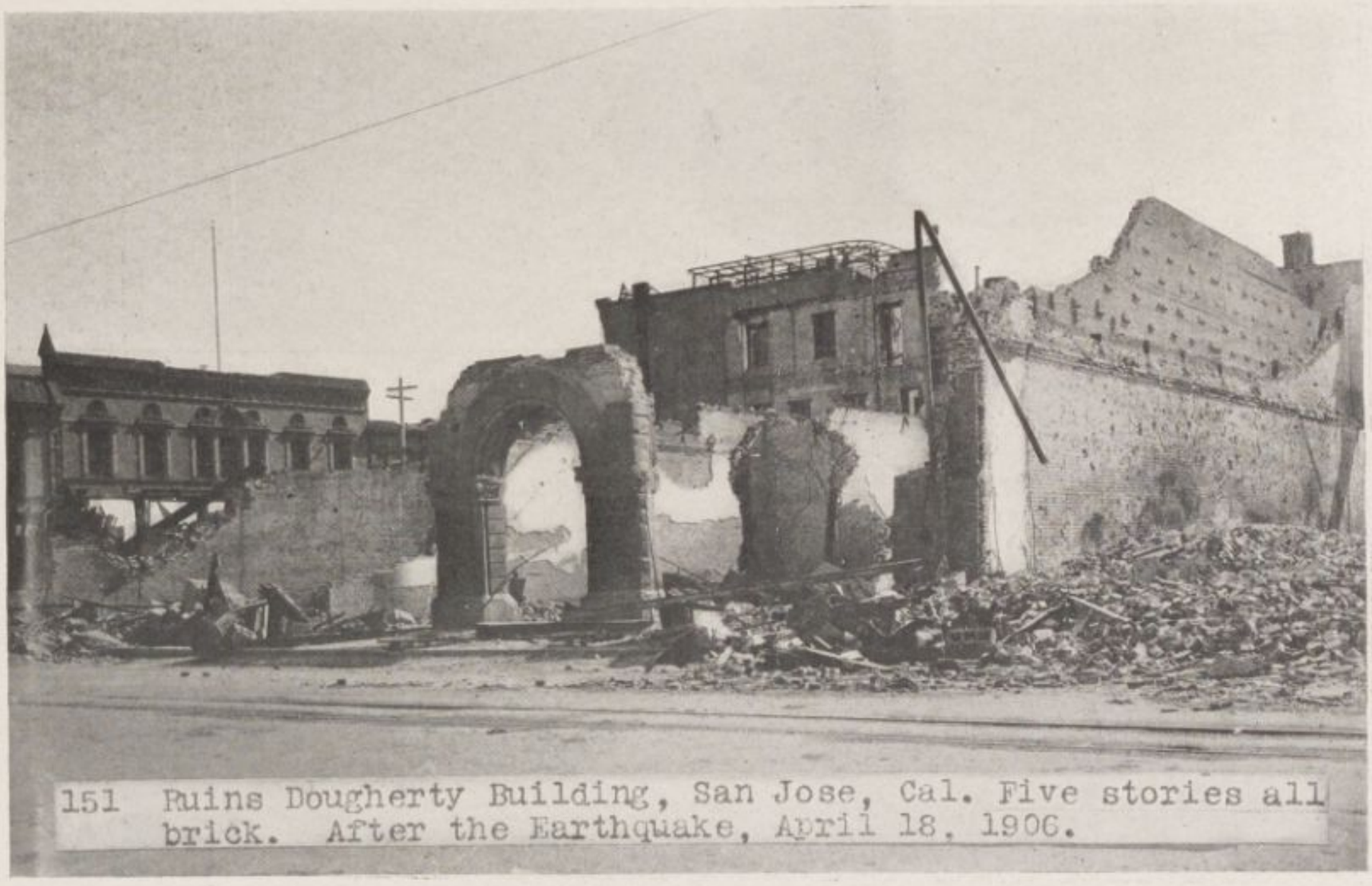
46 Interior ruins of the Memorial Church, Stanford University, Palo Alto, Cal. Wrecked by the earthquake of April 18, 1906.



113 New Hall of Justice just completed, San Jose. After the Earthquake Apr. 18, 1906.



112 Post Office, San Jose, Cal. After Earthquake, Apr. 18, 1906.



151 Ruins Dougherty Building, San Jose, Cal. Five stories all brick. After the Earthquake, April 18, 1906.



103 Annex to Hotel Vendome, San Jose, Cal. After the Earthquake, Apr. 18, 1906. one person killed.



156 Ruins of St. Domonics Church, San Francisco, Cal. after the earthquake and fire, April 18-20, 1906.



57 Oakland building wrecked by the earthquake of April 18th, 1906.

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THE FIRE CONSUMING THE SOUTH SIDE OF MARKET STREET BETWEEN THIRD AND FOURTH STS.

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UNION SQUARE AND ST. FRANCIS HOTEL. BEFORE THE FIRE.



VIEW DOWN ELLIS ST., FROM MASON, SHOWING RUINS OF POODLE DOG RESTAURANT AND NEW FLOOD BUILDING AND THE EMPORIUM.



DYNAMITING THE EXAMINER BUILDING.



LOOKING UP NEW MONTGOMERY ST., THIRD AND MISSION STS., AFTER THE FIRE.



THE BREAD LINE AFTER SAN FRANCISCO FIRE.



SAN FRANCISCO IN FLAMES. EVERY BUILDING IN SIGHT WAS DESTROYED.



VIEW NEAR THE CALL BUILDING AFTER THE FIRE.



CLAUS SPRECKELS (CALL) BUILDING, CORNER OF
THIRD AND MARKET STS. BEFORE THE FIRE.



THE CALL BUILDING, IN THE GRIP OF THE FIRE.
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NEWSPAPER ROW, SHOWING CHRONICLE, PALACE, EXAMINER AND CALL BUILDINGS.



SKYSCRAPERS IN THE GRIP OF THE FIRE.



THE CALL BUILDING ON FIRE AT THE BEGINNING OF THE BIG CONFLAGRATION



THE BURNING OF LINCOLN SCHOOL AND THE METROPOLITAN TEMPLE ON FIFTH STREET.

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MARKET STREET, LOOKING EAST, SHOWING THE CHRONICLE, CROCKER, HOBART AND FERRY BLDGS. AND PALACE HOTEL BEFORE THE FIRE.



UNION FERRY DEPOT, FOOT OF MARKET STREET.



MEMORIAL CHURCH, STANFORD UNIVERSITY. BEFORE THE EARTHQUAKE.



INTERIOR MEMORIAL CHURCH, STANFORD UNIVERSITY. BEFORE THE EARTHQUAKE



Ruins at 5th and B sts., Santa Rosa, Cal., after the earthquake and fire.



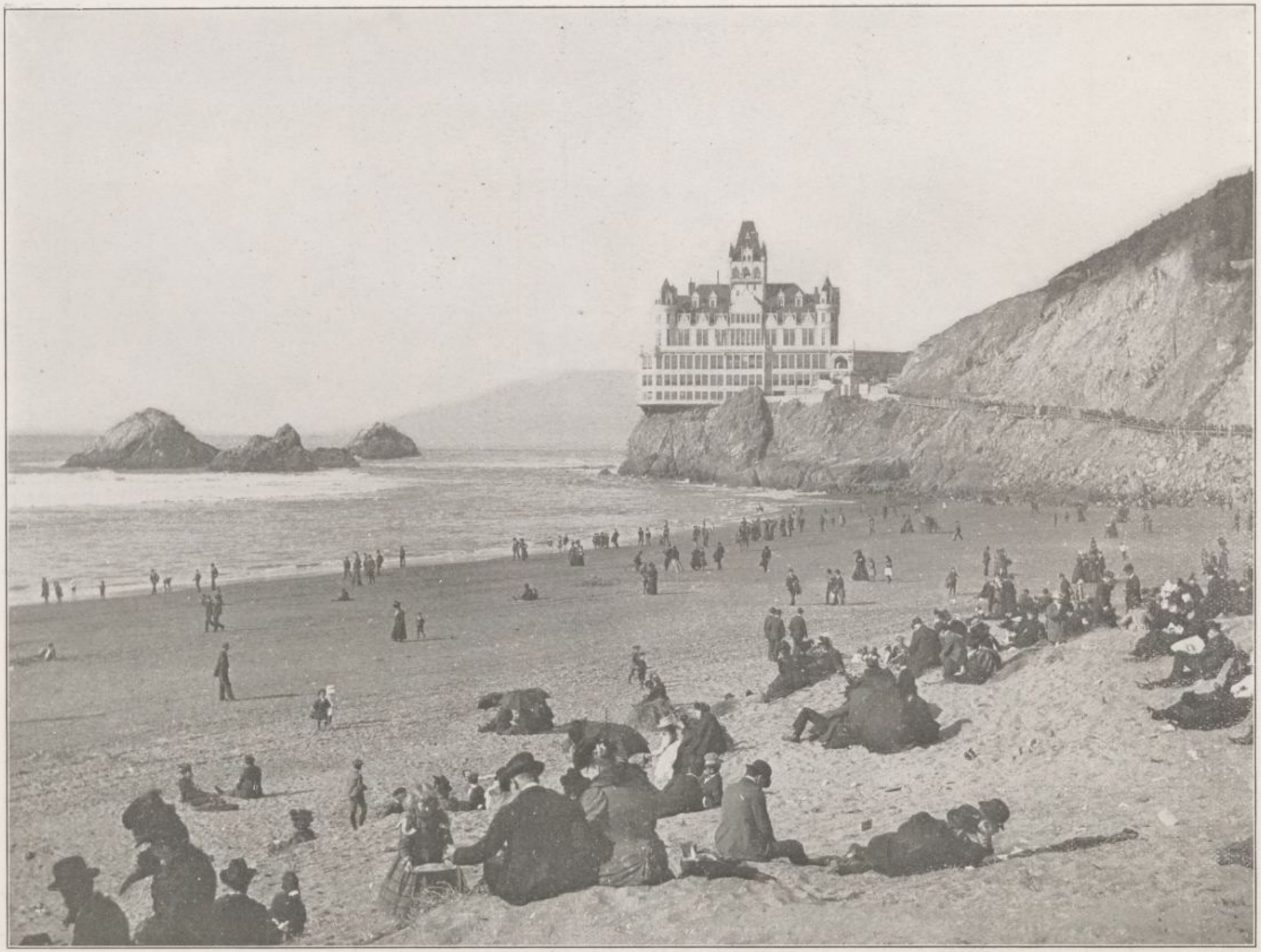
Ruins St. Rose Hotel, Santa Rosa, Cal., after the earthquake and fire.



Ruins Grand Hotel, Santa Rosa, Cal., after the earthquake and fire.



Ruins Court House, Santa Rosa.



CLIFF HOUSE AND SEAL ROCKS. NOT DESTROYED BY FIRE.



REFUGEES OF THE FIRE AT SIXTH AND MISSION STREETS.



PANORAMA OF SAN FRANCISCO AFTER THE BIG FIRE, APRIL 18, 19, 20, 1906.



PANORAMIC VIEW OF SAN FRANCISCO. BEFORE THE FIRE.



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